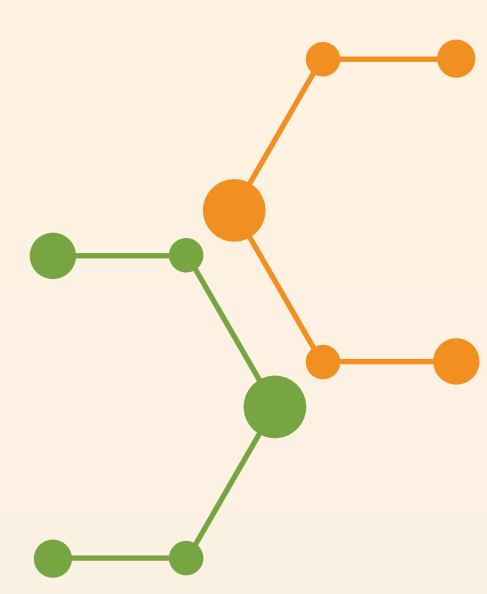




2026

DataConf AGENDA

8:00 - 09:00 Registration

Auditorium

09:00 - 10:15



WELCOME
from your hosts,
Mercia & Candice
with Nantes Kirsten
GM for AI at MTN South Africa

PANEL DISCUSSION

AI Has Changed the Game.
How Do We Lead the Craft?

10:15 - 10:40 Tea break

Auditorium

10:40 - 11:20



Healthcare in the Age of Agents:
The AI Paradigm Shift and its Impact in
a Regulated World
Dr Thabang Mathonsi

Co-Lab



Intellectual and Emotional Obesity -
Fast food in your brain
Geoffrey Lydall

10 Minute movement break

11:30 - 12:10



Trekking to the Data Promised Land:
Building a Data Practice,
Not a Data Team
Thato Mokoena



Thorough, Documented & Wrong:
The Problems Methodology Can't Fix
Abia Duvenage

10 Minute movement break

12:20 - 13:00



Vanta Rising: How I Built an AI-Native
Operating System for a Global
Brand House
Paul Domanski



The Algorithms Inside Generative AI
Rishal Hurbans

13:00 - 14:00 Lunch

14:00 - 14:40



Token Economics:
The Hidden Cost of Every Prompt
Carike Blignaut-Staden



An Introduction to Data Science with
the Help of Banana-Throwing Gorillas
Michael Victor

10 Minute movement break

14:50 - 15:30



Building AI-Accelerated Data Teams:
Sustainable Velocity Across Data
Engineering, Analytics and BI
Daniel Acton



What Does AI Think Africa Looks Like?
An Experiment in LLM Bias
Mfundo Mbambo

10 Minute movement break

15:40 - 16:20



Take The Gap: The Journey from
Data Specialist to Data Leader
Lisema Matsietsi



Turning Data into Stories People
Remember
James McGillivray

16:20 - 17:00

Data Mixer - Social and networking

Sponsor Networking Area

Networking, tea and sponsors exhibition

